

The 2026 Digital Marketing Audit Checklist

47 Points Every Business Should Check

Published by Sovereign Digital Agency

Updated March 2026

Sovereign Digital Agency - sovereigndigitalagency.co.uk.

How to Use This Checklist

This is the exact 47-point audit framework our team uses on every new client engagement. Work through each section systematically, scoring each item as Pass, Partial, or Fail. By the end, you will have a clear picture of where your digital marketing stands and where the biggest opportunities for growth lie.

- PASS = Fully implemented and working correctly
- PARTIAL = Exists but needs improvement
- FAIL = Missing or broken -- priority fix needed
- Focus on FAIL items first for the biggest impact

Section 1: Website Performance (8 Points)

Your website is your digital storefront. If it is slow, broken, or confusing, everything else falls apart.

1. Page load time under 3 seconds on mobile (test at PageSpeed Insights)
2. Google Lighthouse Performance score above 80
3. Mobile-responsive design -- test on iPhone, Android, and tablet
4. No broken links or 404 errors (use Screaming Frog or Ahrefs Site Audit)
5. SSL certificate active (HTTPS padlock showing on all pages)
6. Clear calls-to-action (CTA) on every page -- what do you want visitors to do?
7. Contact information visible on every page (phone, email, or form)
8. Analytics tracking installed and collecting data (GA4 recommended)

Section 2: Technical SEO (8 Points)

Technical SEO is the foundation. Without it, even the best content will struggle to rank.

1. XML sitemap submitted to Google Search Console
2. Robots.txt file configured correctly (not blocking important pages)
3. All pages have unique title tags (under 60 characters, keyword-rich)
4. All pages have unique meta descriptions (under 160 characters, compelling)
5. Proper heading hierarchy (H1 > H2 > H3) on every page
6. Image alt tags present on all images (descriptive, keyword-relevant)
7. No duplicate content issues (check with Siteliner or Copyscape)
8. Structured data (Schema markup) implemented for key pages

Section 3: Content & SEO Strategy (7 Points)

Content drives organic growth. Without a strategy, you are creating content for nobody.

1. Keyword research completed for your top 20 target terms
2. Each key page targets a specific primary keyword

3. Blog or content hub with regular publishing schedule (minimum 2x/month)
4. Content addresses all stages of the buyer journey (awareness, consideration, decision)
5. Internal linking strategy connecting related content
6. Content quality: long-form, well-researched, better than competitors
7. Google Search Console monitored weekly for performance trends

Section 4: Paid Advertising (6 Points)

If you are spending money on ads, every pound should be tracked and optimised.

1. Conversion tracking installed on all platforms (Google, Meta, LinkedIn)
2. Landing pages are specific to each campaign (not sending traffic to homepage)
3. Ad copy includes clear value proposition and strong CTA
4. Negative keywords configured to prevent wasted spend (Google Ads)
5. Audience targeting refined -- not too broad, not too narrow
6. ROAS (Return on Ad Spend) tracked and reviewed weekly

Section 5: Email Marketing (6 Points)

Email remains the highest-ROI marketing channel at approximately \$42 return per \$1 spent.

1. Email list actively growing (opt-in forms on website, lead magnets)
2. Welcome sequence set up for new subscribers (minimum 3-4 emails)
3. Regular newsletter or broadcast emails (minimum 2x/month)
4. Email list segmented by interest, behaviour, or purchase history
5. Subject lines A/B tested regularly
6. Unsubscribe rate below 0.5% and deliverability above 95%

Section 6: Social Media (6 Points)

Social media builds brand awareness and trust. Consistency is more important than virality.

1. Active presence on 2-3 platforms relevant to your audience
2. Consistent posting schedule (minimum 3x/week per platform)
3. Brand voice and visual identity consistent across all platforms
4. Engagement: responding to comments and messages within 24 hours
5. Mix of content types: educational, promotional, social proof, behind-the-scenes
6. Social profiles link back to your website with clear CTAs

Section 7: Lead Generation & Sales (6 Points)

Traffic without conversion is just an expense. Your website needs to capture and convert leads.

1. Lead capture forms on key pages (contact, pricing, resources)

2. Lead magnet or free resource available to capture emails
3. CRM system in place to track leads through the pipeline
4. Follow-up process defined: who contacts leads, when, and how
5. Lead response time under 1 hour during business hours
6. Regular pipeline review: how many leads, what stage, what conversion rate

Scoring Your Audit

Add up your scores across all 47 points. PASS = 2 points. PARTIAL = 1 point. FAIL = 0 points. Maximum score: 94.

- 80-94 (Excellent): Your digital marketing is strong. Focus on optimisation and scaling.
- 60-79 (Good): Solid foundation with clear improvement areas. Targeted fixes will drive growth.
- 40-59 (Average): Significant gaps are costing you leads and revenue. Prioritise FAIL items.
- Below 40 (Needs Work): Major overhaul needed. Consider professional help to accelerate progress.

What Next?

If your score revealed gaps, you are not alone. Most businesses we audit score between 35-55 on their first assessment. The good news: every gap is an opportunity.

At Sovereign Digital Agency, we run this audit (and much more) for every new client. Our team of 40+ specialists and proprietary MONARCH AI platform can take your score from wherever it is today to 80+ within 6 months.

Book a complimentary strategy session at sovereigndigitalagency.co.uk/contact and we will walk through your results together -- no obligation, no pitch. Just actionable insights.

- Free strategy session: sovereigndigitalagency.co.uk/contact
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This checklist is provided free of charge by Sovereign Digital Agency. For a professional audit conducted by our team, book a complimentary strategy session at sovereigndigitalagency.co.uk/contact

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